

Business Analyst Interview Questions and Answers

Q&A - Interview (Technical), Round 1

1. Q: What does a Business Analyst do?

A: A Business Analyst understands the business problem, gathers requirements, works with stakeholders and helps the development team build the right solution. I have practised this through BRDs, user stories, BPMN flows and acceptance criteria in my university projects.

2. Q: What is the difference between functional and non-functional requirements?

A: Functional requirements explain what the system must do, such as allowing a customer to repeat an order. Non-functional requirements explain how the system should work, such as security, usability, performance or offline operation.

3. Q: What is a user story?

A: A user story is a short requirement from the user perspective. For example: As a customer, I want to repeat a previous order so that I can save time. I used this approach in the Darwin Food Delivery Project.

4. Q: What are acceptance criteria?

A: Acceptance criteria are the clear conditions a feature must meet before it is accepted. For repeat orders, I included checks for item availability, payment verification, restaurant acceptance and order confirmation.

5. Q: What is a BRD?

A: A BRD is a Business Requirements Document. It explains the business need, scope, stakeholders, business rules and functional requirements. I prepared one for the Darwin Food Delivery Project.

6. Q: What is an SRS?

A: An SRS is a Software Requirements Specification. It describes the system scope, users, functional and non-functional requirements and constraints. I prepared an SRS for the BioSheild biosecurity exercise simulator.

7. Q: How do you gather requirements?

A: I would identify stakeholders, understand the business problem, ask questions, review current information and document the requirements. I would then validate them with stakeholders before development starts.

8. Q: What is BPMN?

A: BPMN is a way to show a process with activities, decisions and roles. I made BPMN process flows for the food delivery repeat-order feature, including item availability, payment and order confirmation.

9. Q: What is a requirements traceability matrix?

A: A requirements traceability matrix, or RTM, links requirements to system components, development work and testing. In BioSheild, I created an RTM linking requirements to source files and test approaches.

10. Q: What is Jira used for?

A: Jira is used to manage work such as user stories, tasks, bugs, priorities and status. It helps the team see what is planned, in progress and complete.

11. Q: How can SQL help a BA?

A: SQL helps a BA check and analyse data. For example, it can help look at delivery delays, payment status, cancellations or order trends.

12. Q: How would you deal with unclear requirements?

A: I would ask follow-up questions instead of assuming. I would speak with the right stakeholder, document the agreed decision and update the requirement or user story.

Q&A - Behavioral

1. Q: Tell me about yourself.

A: I am completing a Master of Information Technology in Software Engineering at Charles Darwin University. I have practical BA experience from the Darwin Food Delivery Project and BioSheild, where I worked on requirements, process mapping, user stories, acceptance criteria and traceability. I also support website and digital work as an intern at Launchpod Australia. I am looking for an entry-level BA role where I can keep learning and contribute to real projects.

2. Q: Why do you want to become a Business Analyst?

A: I enjoy understanding problems and making information clear for different people. I like working between users, stakeholders and technical teams. My project experience showed me that I enjoy turning business needs into requirements and practical processes.

3. Q: Tell me about a time you worked with different stakeholders.

A: Context: In the Darwin Food Delivery Project, different groups had different needs, including customers, drivers, restaurants, support staff and finance teams. Action: I considered these needs while documenting business rules, workflows and operational requirements. Result: The requirements covered issues such as payment, cancellations, driver safety and local delivery constraints.

4. Q: Tell me about a challenge you faced in a project.

A: Context: The food delivery project had local delivery challenges such as low mobile coverage, bad weather and road closures. Action: I documented these as operational requirements and considered how they could affect cancellations, driver safety and payment reconciliation. Result: The project requirements became more realistic for the Darwin context.

5. Q: Tell me about a time you organised work for a team.

A: Context: During my Launchpod internship, website and digital tasks needed to be kept organised. Action: I supported the team by organising business requirements, managing content deliverables, tracking implementation tasks and keeping documentation central. Result: This helped the team keep work visible and support smoother project delivery.

6. Q: Tell me about a time you used data.

A: Context: At NT Fire and Emergency Services, I supported communication activities. Action: I analysed social media data and prepared reports to show the information clearly. Result: The reports supported communication planning and gave the team useful information for their activities.

7. Q: How do you communicate with non-technical people?

A: I use simple language and avoid technical terms when they are not needed. I use examples, diagrams and short summaries. Then I check understanding so that everyone agrees before moving to the next step.

8. Q: Tell me about a time you learnt a new skill quickly.

A: Context: I needed to build BA skills while completing my Master of IT and projects. Action: I practised requirements documentation, BPMN, Jira, SQL and related tools through small project tasks. Result: I built a practical foundation that I used in the food delivery and BioSheild projects.

9. Q: What is your main strength?

A: My main strength is organising information clearly. I can take a business problem and turn it into requirements, process flows, user stories or a clear task list. This helps people understand what needs to be done.

10. Q: What is an area you are developing?

A: I am still developing deeper workplace experience with tools such as SQL and Jira. I have a foundation from projects and study, and I am continuing to practise so I can use them more confidently in a professional setting.

11. Q: How do you handle disagreement in a team?

A: I listen first to understand the different views. Then I focus on the project goal, user needs and evidence. If there are still different options, I document them clearly and ask the accountable person to make the final decision.

12. Q: Why should we hire you?

A: I bring current IT study, practical BA project work and digital-team experience. I have worked with BRDs, SRS documents, BPMN, user stories, acceptance criteria and traceability. I am organised, open to feedback and ready to learn in an entry-level BA role.

Q&A - Technical, Round 2

1. Q: How would you approach a new feature request?

A: I would first understand the business problem and who will use the feature. Then I would identify stakeholders, gather requirements, map the current process if needed, write user stories and acceptance criteria, prioritise the work and validate it before development starts.

2. Q: Explain the repeat-order feature you worked on.

A: The feature allowed customers to repeat a previous order. I created BPMN flows that included checking item availability, payment verification, restaurant acceptance and final order confirmation.

3. Q: What is the difference between a user story and a task?

A: A user story explains the value needed by a user. A task is a piece of work needed to complete the story. For example, repeat order is a story, while testing payment validation can be a task.

4. Q: What is UAT?

A: UAT means User Acceptance Testing. It is when users or business representatives test the solution to check that it meets their needs and acceptance criteria before release.

5. Q: How would you support testing as a BA?

A: I would make sure requirements and acceptance criteria are clear, help review test scenarios, answer questions from testers, clarify defects and support UAT with stakeholders.

6. Q: What makes a good requirement?

A: A good requirement is clear, specific, testable, realistic and linked to a business need. It should be easy for both stakeholders and technical team members to understand.

7. Q: How would you manage a requirement change?

A: I would document the change, understand why it is needed and check its impact on scope, time, testing and other requirements. After approval, I would update the relevant documents, backlog and traceability links.

8. Q: What non-functional requirements did you consider in BioSheild?

A: I considered security, usability, performance and offline operation. These were important because the simulator needed to support training scenarios and work reliably in different conditions.

9. Q: How did you prioritise requirements in BioSheild?

A: I looked at the value of each requirement for the training simulator and documented priorities for areas such as AI response analysis, branching narratives, multiplayer exercises, scoring, security and offline operation.

10. Q: What information would you check when analysing delivery delays?

A: I would check order time, restaurant acceptance time, driver assignment, pickup time, delivery time, location, weather, road conditions and cancellation reason. Then I would look for patterns.

11. Q: What is the purpose of a backlog?

A: A backlog is a prioritised list of work, including user stories, tasks, bugs and improvements. It helps the team decide what should be done next.

12. Q: How would you explain a technical issue to a stakeholder?

A: I would use plain language and focus on the impact on the user or business. I would explain the options, any risks and the recommended next step without using unnecessary technical jargon.

13. Q: How do you make sure documentation is accurate?

A: I confirm details with stakeholders, use a clear template, review for gaps, link requirements to acceptance criteria and update documents whenever a decision changes.

14. Q: What can Power BI be used for in BA work?

A: Power BI can create reports and dashboards from data. A BA can use it to show trends such as delivery delays, cancellations, user activity or performance results.

15. Q: What questions would you ask before building a checkout feature?

A: I would ask who will use it, which payment methods are needed, how split checkout will work, how payment failures are handled, what receipt details are required, what security rules apply and how success will be measured.

16. Q: How do you use wireframes in requirements work?

A: Wireframes provide a simple visual idea of a screen or user journey. I would use them to discuss usability with stakeholders early and make sure the layout supports the user story before development starts.